Parent Council Meeting

October 12TH, 2022

Start Time: 6:30pm
End Time: 8:30pm
Location: Highland Public School 125 Salisbury Ave Cambridge ON
Facilitator: Tara Pederson
Author: Natalie Bender, Secretary

Members in Attendance: please note that Secretary was not able to identify all participating members

Introduction:

Jessica Allen

Tania Gonsalves Witney

Connie

Christine Drew Smith

Alley

Cynthia Solowieczyk Co Secretary

Natalie Bender, Co Secretary

April Lindemann

Terri Leskien

Yomi Aroso, Vice Principal Sean

Finn, Principal

Paula Ouellet

Tara Pederson, Chair

Agenda for Parent Council October 12th distributed by Tara Pederson, Chair and Introduced herself. Minutes approved by Terri L and Paula O.

Nominations and appointments for the year proceeded as:

- Tara Pederson, Chair along with Co Chair Connie (last name unknown and will be update with further details next meeting)
- Secretary, Natalie Bender and Cynthia Solowieczyk
- Treasurer, Stacey (last name unknown and will be update with further details next meeting) and April Lindemann to support when needed

Principals Message:

Mr. Finn greeted Parent Council and reviewed construction is mostly done except for a few things to go over during winter break. New gym mats are in the gym. Terry Fox run raised $3000.00

Students Lead "Orange Shirt Day Assembly"

Fall play was successful and ran by Mme. Dahmer, Ms. Jarmen and Mr Hughes.
Highland Open House was also a success and 14-15 Bankers Boxes will filled with donated books. Ms. J. Allen will support this for next year again.

Grades 4,5, and 6 Dodge Ball intramurals will begin.

Next assembly will be for November 11th, 2022 Remembrance Day

Pizza Day will now be facilitated by Administration of Highland Public School

Junior Climber is off limits due to low mulch and chains requiring shortening for safety purposes. Playground was confirmed to be in good working condition otherwise and will open soon after mulch is restored and chains are fixed.

Additional Notes:

In house focus has been related to 3 R's: Responsibility Respect and Resilience

Highland Public School uses "WITS" to address/support conflict resolution Walk away, Ignore, Talk it out, and Seek Help.

Paid help is needed for SMACA and to apply you may speak to Admin and go through interview

process WRDSB focus this year is on Science of Reading and Science Based Practices

Further Discussion will be needed for Kiss n' Ride policies and signage

Portable updates: One will be leaving Highland PS and moving to another school end of October and the other portable on property is condemned and further details are unknown at this time.

Challenges at Highland discussed:

Staff and people resources are spread to thin, 4 EA's total in the entire school; too many needs for students and not enough support

Kindergarten has increased needs and no IEP's in place/developed

VOLUNTEERS WELCOME: Flexibility in different classrooms (not just your young person's classroom) is encouraged

Strong Start program not yet available

Additional Information:

Fence will be coming for Kindergarten hopefully by winter; Mr. Finn has noted he was hoping to share this detail in November Parent Council Meeting

Fund Raiser Ideas:

Concerns related to Parent Council and School competing for funds and admin will streamline Pizza Day.

Fundraising by Parent Council Funds go towards Science Night, Scholastic Book Fair, and Movie Night. These events cost approximately $5500 (unknown cost for Scholastic book fair)

Parent Council will raise funds for events through other methods than Pizza Day by selling popcorn and/or cookies on School Day. This will be purchased with Admin Support and opted for on School-Day.

Snack day will be on Friday and Parent Council Volunteers for Snack Delivery include:

Paula

Tania

Whitney

Natalie

Preferred Snack Day: Friday

Wrap up:

Voted to end meeting. Meeting adjourned at 8:30pm. Next Parent Council Meeting will be held on Wednesday November 9th, 2022 at Highland Public School at 6:30pm.